MAL B – English translation (de Ridder 2021, TCMA)

Web: https://oracc.museum.upenn.edu/tcma/P281780/html

Project translation extracted from the ORACC HTML view (rank 3 in our hierarchy; consult only after our own reading).
Each paragraph: [first label – last label of the transliteration lines it translates] text. "## " = section heading.

[o ii 1] § 1: [If brothers divide the estate of their father], orchards and wells in the land; the oldest son shall select and take two shares [(x)], his brothers will select and take (a share) after one other. The youngest apportions whatever dependents there are and of all the movable goods in the field. The oldest son will select and take one share and take and for his second share he will cast his lot with his brothers.
[o ii 15] § 2: If a man, among brothers who have not divided, has ended a life; they shall give him to the next-of-kin. The next-of-kin will kill him if he wants to, or if he wants to come to an agreement and take his inheritance share.
[o ii 22] § 3: If a man among brothers, who have not divided, speaks treason, or flees; his share is as the king determines.
[o ii 27] § 4: [If] brothers (have) an undivided field and there is one brother amongst them [...] sowed seed and [...] cultivated the field. [A second brother] has come and took the seed of his brother's cultivated field for a second time, and they proved charges against him and convicted him; [on the day] he will come forward, [the brother who] cultivated [the field] will take [his share].
[o ii 39] § 5: [If brother (have)] an undivided [field, and one brother] among them [...].
[o iii 1] § 6: [...] will take [...] for silver. When he has not yet taken the field or house for silver, he will have the herald proclaim 3 times in one month in the city of Aššur, and he will make him proclaim 3 times in the inner city of the field and house that he will take, thus: "I will take the field or house of so-and-so son of so-and-so in the meadows of this city for silver. Those present who (want) to take (it as well) or contest it should bring forward their tablets and place them before the representatives; they can contest, they can clear it (for themselves), and they can take it. Those who during this month, without forgetting the term, will have brought their tablets and place before the representatives; the man (whose claim is successful) will take the field to its full extent." When the herald proclaims in the city, one from the king's ministers, city scribe, herald, and representatives of the king will be present. The one about to take the village, field and house, the mayor, 3 chiefs of the city will also be present. They will make the herald proclaim, and they will write they tablets and give them, (thus): "Within 1 month the herald has proclaimed 3 times, he who did not bring his tablet in this month or did not place it before the

representatives has forfeited his claim to the house and field. It is clear for the one who made the herald proclaim." They will write 3 tablets of the herald's proclamations of the judges.
[o iv 1] § 7: [...] as much as [...] he will claim [...] and for the price of the house [that ...] he demolished [...] he will give twice the price of the house [...] to the owner of the house. They will beat him 5 (times) with sticks for 1 talent of lead. He will perform service for the king for 1 month.
[o iv 11] § 8: If a man incorporates a large border area of his peer, they wil prove charges against him and convict him; he will give three times the field as he incorporated and they will cut of 1 finger, they will beat him 100 (times) with sticks, and he will perform service for the king for one month.
[o iv 20] § 9: If a man transfers a small border of the lots, they will prove charge against him and convict him. He will give 1 talent of lead, three times as much field as he incorporated tin, they will beat him 50 (times) with sticks, and he will perform service for the king for one month.
[o iv 29] If a man dug a well and built a fortified farmstead in a field that he does not own, than he will forfeit his claim on his well and fortified farmstead, they will beat him 30 (times) with sticks, and he will perform service for the king for 20 days. If [...] fortified farmstead [...] he will swear. [...]
[r v 1] § 11: (fragmentary)[...] he will give to the creditor.
[r v 13] § 12: If a man founded an orchard, digs a well, grows trees in a field not his own, and the lord of the field sees it, but does not [come forward]; the orchard is clear for its founder and he will give a field like the (other) field to the lord of the orchard.
[r v 19] § 13: If a man founded an orchard, digs a well, grows trees or vegetables in a field not his own, and they proved charged against him and convicted him; when the owner of the field comes, he will take the orchard together with its equipment.
[r v 26] § 14: If a man flattens(?) a field that is not his own and makes bricks, they proved charged against him and convicted him; he will give the plot three times, they will take the bricks, they will beat him 50 (times) with sticks, and he perform service for the king for 1 month.
[r v 34] § 15: [If a man] made bricks on a field, not his own, [...]; they will take his [bricks], beat him [x (times) with sticks], and he will perform [service for the king for x days].

[r vi 1] § 16: [...] not [...]

[r vi 2] § 17: [If] there is enough water available to be used for irrigation, the owners of fields will stand together, and a man will do the work according to the extent of his field and irrigate the field. If there are amongst them who are not willing, the one who is willing will ask the judges, take a tablet of the judges, and perform the work; he will take those waters for himself, irrigate his field, (but) nobody else may irrigate.

[r vi 21] § 18: If there is enough rainwater available to be used for irrigation, the owners of fields will stand together and a man will do the work according to the extent of his field and irrigate the field. If there are amongst them who are not willing, the one who is willing will take a tablet of the judges to those not agreeing, [the mayor] and 5 chiefs [of the city will stand together ...]. They

will beat him [with sticks], and he will perform [service for the king for x days].
[r vii 4] § 19: [If a man intends] to cultivate the field of his comrade, and [...] prevented him. He [swore] the oath of the king for him and cultivated it. If [...] came forward, the cultivator of the field shall harvest barley at the harvest time, thresh the grain, and store in the granary. [...] he will return it to the barn. He will give two shares to the [owner] of the field in accordance with yield of a field of the city.
[r vii 18] § 20: [If] a man dug [...] in a field that does not belong to him, surrounds it with a border, sets up a boundary stone, [...] he said. They proved charges against him and convicted him [...].

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